

DANIEL YEWENU

Cyber security Analyst & Security Engineer | VAPT | Application & API Security | Cloud Infrastructure | Security Automation

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cyber security Analyst and Penetration Tester who thinks offensively first, finding real risk before attackers do. Led a full authorized security assessment engagement for Drowzy, operating under signed NDA and Rules of Engagement, identifying a Critical-severity vulnerability and independently verifying remediation through formal retest. Built AdaptiveShield, an autonomous reinforcement-learning firewall, end-to-end and authored the accompanying research paper, conditionally accepted for IEEE publication. Holds 10+ certifications including Cisco Ethical Hacker, AWS Cloud Practitioner, and ISC² CC, with a 90%+ vulnerability detection rate across live engagements.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Penetration Testing & VAPT · Web & API Security Testing · Vulnerability Research · OWASP Top 10 · Authorized Assessment Lifecycle (Scoping, NDA, RoE, Retest) · Network Security & Traffic Forensics · Reinforcement Learning for Security Automation · Python & Automation

SELECTED ENGAGEMENTS & RESEARCH

Drowzy : Authorized Security Assessment (Neurastia)

2026

Signed NDA · Rules of Engagement · Web & Mobile Application Security

- Led a full-lifecycle authorized security assessment of Drowzy's web and mobile application under signed NDA and Rules of Engagement, from scoping through final retest.
- Identified a Critical-severity vulnerability, obtained source-level access to remediate it properly rather than patch the compiled build, and independently verified the fix through formal retest.
- Delivered a complete engagement package : findings log, business and technical impact analysis, and a Security Assurance Certificate confirming verified remediation.

AdaptiveShield : Autonomous Reinforcement-Learning Firewall

2026 · Paper Conditionally Accepted, IEEE

Python · Reinforcement Learning · Network Security · Academic Research

- Designed and built an autonomous firewall from the ground up that learns optimal traffic-filtering policies in real time using reinforcement learning, engineering the reward structure to balance security posture against throughput.
- Authored the accompanying research paper as lead author (academic supervisor served as advisor); paper conditionally accepted for IEEE publication.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity intern

2025 - May 2026

Interswitch Group · Internship - Lagos Nigeria

- Applied SWOT analysis and the McKinsey 7S framework to assess organizational cybersecurity readiness, identifying capability gaps and building a phased 2025–2028 implementation roadmap with defined KPIs
- Recommended structural improvements including direct CISO-to-CEO reporting alignment, periodic Red Team/Blue Team exercises, and a cross-functional Cybersecurity Advisory Board
- Developed and presented "CyberSecure Nexora," a comprehensive cybersecurity strategy for a fintech case study, spanning technology (AI-driven fraud detection, Zero Trust architecture), compliance (DORA, NDPR, PCI-DSS, ISO 27001, GDPR), and talent development

Cybersecurity Intern

Aug 2025

Employment Express Verband LLP · Remote - Lagos State, Nigeria

- Conducted full-scope VAPT on partner projects (CrexBet, LTSU), identifying critical vulnerabilities across web application and network attack surfaces.
- Executed structured penetration tests using Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, and Nmap, documenting findings mapped to OWASP Top 10 with CVSS-scored risk ratings and remediation guidance.

Network Security Intern

Jun 2025 – Aug 2025

Redynox · Remote India

- Conducted web application vulnerability assessments on WebGoat using OWASP ZAP on Kali Linux, identifying SQL Injection, XSS, and CSRF vulnerabilities with full remediation documentation.

- Performed deep-packet network traffic analysis with Wireshark, detecting unauthorized port scans and anomalous activity across live network environments.

Cybersecurity Intern

Feb 2025 – Mar 2025

Hacktify · Remote - Lagos, Nigeria

- Executed penetration testing using Burp Suite, Nmap, and OWASP ZAP, achieving a 90% vulnerability detection rate across all assessed systems.
- Performed end-to-end VAPT of Hacktify's infrastructure, uncovering critical misconfigurations aligned to OWASP Top 10; awarded the Hacktify Penetration Testing Certificate.

ADDITIONAL PROJECTS

ENSOP : Enterprise Network Security Operations Platform

2026

pfSense · Suricata · Wazuh · ELK Stack · Kali Linux · MITRE ATT&CK

- Self-hosted Zero Trust network lab with VLAN-segmented zones; runs MITRE ATT&CK-mapped red-team simulations to validate detection coverage.

Zero Trust Architecture : Hybrid Environment

2025

NIST SP 800-207 · AWS · O365

- Designed a NIST SP 800-207-compliant Zero Trust framework for hybrid AWS/O365/VPN environments with STRIDE threat modeling.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Offensive Security: Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, Nmap, Metasploit, SQLmap, Kali Linux, Android studio(App testing)

Networking & Forensics: Wireshark, pfSense, 802.1Q VLANs, network traffic analysis

Programming: Python, Bash scripting, NumPy (RL and cryptography implementations)

Cloud & Platforms: AWS (Cloud Practitioner certified), Ubuntu, Windows Server

SIEM & Detection: Elastic Stack (ELK), Splunk, Wazuh, Suricata, Zeek

Frameworks & Standards: OWASP Top 10, MITRE ATT&CK, NIST SP 800-207, NIST CSF, PCI DSS, GDPR

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Computer Forensics Analyst (CCFA) — eSecurity Institute, September 2026
- Certified Ransomware Protection Officer (CRPO) — EU Cyber Academy, Dec 2025
- AWS Cloud Practitioner — Amazon Web Services, Aug 2025
- Securing LLM and NLP APIs; Building Security into AI; API Security for PCI Compliance — APIsec University, Jul 2025
- Cisco CyberOps Associate & Cisco Certified Ethical Hacker — Cisco Networking Academy, May 2025
- Security Operations & Defense Analyst — Splunk, Sep 2023
- Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) — ISC², Dec 2022

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Cybersecurity

Expected Nov 2026

Lead City University · Ibadan, Nigeria

Cybersecurity, Ethical Hacking & CyberOps Associate

2025

Cisco Networking Academy — Network Security, Ethical Hacking, Incident Response, Security Best Practices

Cybersecurity, AI & Compliance

Jun 2024 – Sep 2025

APIsec University — API security testing, penetration testing, AI/LLM security, PCI compliance